

Cinema As A Catalyst For Economic Development In Nigeria

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Abstract

This study aims to explore how Nollywood can be leveraged as a tool for Nigeria's economic development and cultural diplomacy amidst ongoing economic challenges. Its objective is to identify industry practices, such as storytelling, production quality, and audience engagement that can promote growth and cultural identity. Using Cultural Economics Theory, which links cultural commodities to economic activities such as job creation, tourism, and international branding of Nigeria's cultural products, the research investigates how films reflect societal values while fostering economic development. The research fills a literature gap by empirically networking Nollywood's practices to economic outcomes and accentuates cinema's role in fostering viable development and global trade. Employing a qualitative approach, the study combines content analysis of popular Nollywood films and interviews with industry practitioners. Findings reveal that movies rooted in local traditions, languages, and social realism, while incorporating universal themes, effectively attract international audiences, expand markets, and contribute to economic growth. The study highlights strategies for balancing cultural authenticity with global appeal and provides evidence-based case studies illustrating this impact. It recommends infrastructural improvement, and policy structures to nurture workable growth, protect intellectual property rights, and improve Nigeria's cultural and economic influence.

Keywords: Cultural diplomacy, economic development, global markets, cultural branding, success models, cultural commodities.

Introduction

Motion picture has long been established as a persuasive medium of cultural expression and social influence. In Nigeria, the Nollywood industry has come forth to be one of the largest and most influential film industries in Africa. Beyond entertainment, cinema in Nigeria holds fundamental possibility as a catalyst for economic development. It creates employment, affects local economies, advances tourism, and promotes cultural commercialism. Many filmmakers and actors have gained global recognition, and the industry continues to grow rapidly. Despite its fame, scholarly understanding of how digital distribution platforms influence Nollywood's economic sustainability remains limited. This research addresses this gap by examining the impact of digital strategies like streaming platforms (Netflix, Amazon Prime, Video-On-

Demand, etc.), international co-productions, and social media marketing on Nollywood's industry growth. Significantly, it strengthens the importance of cinema as an indispensable tool for national economic growth and cultural dialogue in Nigeria.

The Nigerian cinema in the context of this study, is any film produced in Nigeria or produced by a Nigerian filmmaker; the cinema has a history dates back to late 19th century and into the colonial period in the early 20th century. The history and evolution of the Nigerian film industry is often categorised into four main eras such as; the Colonial era, Golden era, Video film era and the emerging New Nigerian cinema era (Emeagwali, 2004, pp.231-238).

Nollywood is not just a cultural phenomenon but a substantive economic contributor that can enhance national GDP's trajectory. The need to use African prints and fabrics as costumes is on the rise reasonably, as filmmakers and costume designers seek to integrate native Nigerian designs into their productions, which is also an economic boost created by the activities of Nollywood industry in the Nigerian economy. According to News report as cited in *Financial Street Magazine* May 19, 2020, in 2016 alone Nollywood industry “accounted for N853.9B (1.42 %) of the country's Gross Domestic Product. In 2018, 0.21 % of the GDP was valued at 270 billion Naria. This was contributed by the arts, entertainment and creative industry. In the first three months of 2019, the industry garnered 0.27% of the GDP, which was valued at N870B” (Ufuoma, 2020). PricewaterhouseCoopers (PwC) as cited in Abulude (2024, p.1) the, “Nigeria's film industry in 2021 contributed 2.3% (\$660M (239 billion Naria)) to Gross Domestic Product (GDP)”. It is the efforts of film actors, costume designers, cinematographers, set designers, directors and producers that brought about the increase in wealth creation through the activities of Nigerian cinema per capita income of the teeming youths, which improves their standard of living. Amazingly, African International Film Festival (AFRIFF 2023) magazine says that Nollywood film industry “employs more than three hundred thousand persons directly and up to a million indirectly, making it one of Nigeria's largest employers”.

Interestingly, existing literature spotlights Nollywood's economic importance and cultural influence. Street (2013, pp. 28-39) and Ogunleye (2015, pp. 45-60) document its role in employment, GDP contribution, and cultural representation. Recent scholarship (Akinola & Nwachukwu, 2023, pp. 120-135; Ojo, 2025, pp. 78-94) emphasises digital platforms such as Netflix and YouTube as game-changers, increasing market access and revenue expansion. Conversely, a notable gap exists in systematic empirical analyses linking digital distribution strategies to specific economic outcomes within Nollywood. This research fills this gap by combining qualitative content analysis with industry practitioner interviews to systematically appraise how digital strategies serve as catalysts for economic growth within the framework of Cultural Economics Theory. Notwithstanding, industry reports (PwC, 2022 and Nigerian Bureau of Statistics (NBS), 2022) suggest promising growth, academic research that meticulously evaluates how digitalisation influences employment, and export earnings yet the industry sustainability remains tiny. This study therefore, aims to integrate theoretical insights with empirical data. One of the empirical cases is Funke Akindele's *Behind The Scenes*, (2025) film, which demonstrates how digital marketing and streaming partnerships make multiple revenue streams, supports job creation, and boost Nigeria's cultural exports.

Definition of Terms

These concepts are used interchangeably, therefore, find below the definitions of each as applied in the context of this study:

- i. **Cinema:** The art and industry of film production, distribution, and exhibition. However, in the context of Nollywood and African film studies, cinema refers to the filmmaking patterns, narratives, aesthetic styles, and cultural expressions that emerge from the Nigerian film industry and bigger African film traditions that reflect local stories, social issues, and cultural identities. Generally, "cinema" in this context is both a creative industry and a cultural phenomenon that reflects and influences African societies, offering insights into their histories, identities, and aspirations.
- ii. **Nollywood:** Nigeria's indigenous film industry, characterised by low-budget productions, rapid production cycles, wide availability to local audiences and different storytelling rooted in Nigerian culture.
- iii. **Cultural Economy:** The study of how cultural products and services render economic value through market activities, employment, and cultural diplomacy. In essence, the Cultural Economy of Nollywood examines how cultural practices, storytelling, and film production are embedded within economic systems, defining both Nigeria's economy and its cultural identity on a national and international scale.
- iv. **Creative Economy:** An economic system where creative thinking, cultural expression, and intellectual property drive development and innovation. In the context of this study and Nollywood, the Creative Economy refers to the sector where cultural, artistic, and creative activities such as film production, music, fashion, and new media generate economic value and contribute to innovation, employment, and cultural pride that position Nigeria as a vibrant centre of creative industries on the world stage.
- v. **Economic Development:** The process of improving economic well-being and standard of life through growth, business, and infrastructure. In the context of Nollywood and this study, economic development pertains to the processes by which the industry contribute to the overall economic growth, poverty reduction, job creation, and better quality life in Nigeria, which involves knowing both the direct financial impacts and the indirect socio-economic improvements motivated by the industry's growth.
- vi. **Cultural Diplomacy:** This involves using cultural possessions, like Nollywood films, music, etc. to further international relationships, improve Nigeria's image globally, and better cultural understanding. It takes advantage of Nollywood's popularity as a soft power tool in building diplomatic ties.
- vii. **Cultural Branding:** This speaks on how Nollywood movies are marketed to create a constructive image and identity globally. This branding extends to attracting tourism, investments, and international audiences.
- viii. **Sustainable Development:** This refers to economic growth that is environmentally accountable, societal inclusivity, and culturally consequential. Nollywood's part in sustainable

development is through promoting localised culture, empowering communities, and aiding long-term economic gains that do not endanger emerging generations.

Succinctly, the conceptual frameworks are interconnected as cinema is the broad industry of movie production and distribution. Nollywood is a key part of cinema that operates in Nigeria, producing specific cultural stories and contributing same to the nation's cultural economy.

Theoretical Framework

Cultural Economics Theory examines the economic characteristics of culture, regarding culture as an economic asset. It analyses how cultural goods and services are produced, valued, and apportioned within markets. Meanwhile, the main proponent is David Throsby in early 1990s. Its relevance to cinema as a catalyst for economic development in Nigeria reveals how cinema suffices not only as a form of artistic aspect but also as a potent catalyst for national economic improvement. Within the prototype of cultural economics, cinema contributes significantly to Nigeria's Gross Domestic Product (GDP), provides livelihoods for thousands of actors, directors, technical crews, and supports service providers. By rating cinema as an economic product, policymakers and stakeholders can have strategies that enable growth and sustainability.

However, Cultural Economics underscores understanding the structure and performance of cultural industries. In Nigeria, the movie industry's production and distribution outlets have evolved rapidly, leveraging both conventional and digital platforms. Dissecting these markets dynamics in order to identify bottlenecks, opportunities for investment and for improving industry efficiency, Nollywood should stick to technology so as to harness its prospects. For example, streaming platforms can increase reach and income, while policy reforms can fortify intellectual property rights, ensuring creators gain reasonably from their work. Another aspect of the significance of this theory is in the area of employment generation and poverty reduction; knowing that the Nigerian film industry aid in job creation, providing direct line of works to hundreds and indirectly supporting related sectors such as hospitality, transportation, textile industry through fabrics used for costumes and designs, marketing, and retail. This fits with the economic development goal of poverty alleviation through different business creations.

Ogunleye (2015, pp.453-470) says that the economic effect of Nollywood helps in the growth of Nigeria's economy, in that the activities of Nollywood has advanced the national integration and upliftment of the standard of living. Meanwhile, Ogbebor (2014, pp. 245-259) investigates how cultural economics influences Nollywood's industry structure as cultural choice in storytelling practices influence Nollywood's production types, distribution channels, and genre development, creating a unique industry structure embedded in Nigerian cultural narratives; employment, which creates opportunities for local talent, craftsman, and filmmakers, thereby promoting job creation in culturally pertinent contexts and international appeal, as Nollywood films in cultural content, language, and ideas connect with both Nigerians in diaspora and other international audiences, helping Nollywood's global reach and marketability.

Aderinoye (2018, pp. 121- 138) underlines the import of cultural industries, including cinema in nation's economic expansion and developmental strategies. Here it highlights film as a cultural commodity that has different processes in achieving the final product and at each stage,

economic activities exchange financial rewards. Other scholars like Ogunleye & Oduntan (2017, pp. 333-351), furnish verifiable data on Nollywood's attempt to increase Nigeria's GDP, analyzing its contributions in employment generation, and export revenue earnings, which expatiate the economic relevance of the Nollywood industry in national development. Street (2013, pp.203-218) explains how economic theories of cultural industries apply to African cinema, including Nollywood and other creative ventures in the African context.

More importantly, the theory suggests that cinema is not merely a form of recreation but an important sector that can stir up economic change, especially in a developing society like Nigeria. By leaning on cultural narratives and creative gifts, the Nigerian cinema can serve as a catalyst for bigger economic development. Uwah (2024, pp.13-15), sees cinema as a “formidable platforms and spaces to serve the society in identity construction”. This statement indicates the power of cinema in affecting the society and national economy. Fortunately, cinema in Nigeria exceeds its role as a medium of entertainment to become an impressive engine of economic development. Its capacity to generate employment, attract foreign investment, and promote cultural tourism evaluates its significance as a strategic industry. While industry stakeholders underline technical quality and marketing strategies, scholarly literature suggests that integration of digital distribution will not only enlarge market reach but also decreases piracy. This agrees with Cultural Economics Theory, which postulates that cultural commodities when properly marketed using digital platforms can greatly boost jobs and GDP.

Therefore, a strategic shift towards digital distributions supported by empirical evidence from new Nollywood's case study such as Kemi Adetiba's films signal a bright pathway for sustainable economic growth. Again, applying Cultural Economics Theory in this case study, illustrates how digital circulation transforms Nollywood films from localised cultural commodities into globally marketable assets, generating employment and export earnings. The theory opines that when cultural goods are efficaciously sold and distributed, they stimulate economic activity. This is evident in the international success of the film like *King of Boys* (2018), which took advantage of international streaming platforms to reach diverse audiences.

Methodology

Research Design

This study employs a qualitative research design, combining content analysis of ten (10) recent Nollywood films chosen based on popularity and distribution range, with semi-structured interviews involving fifteen (15) industry practitioners, which include producers, directors, distributors, and digital platform handlers selected through purposive sampling. Content analysis followed a coding model, which focuses on thematic elements related to cultural content, distribution channels, and profitable impact. Data were analysed textually and transcribed to identify designs correlating digital strategies with economic results. The combined methods allow a comprehensive understanding of the qualitative aspects of Nollywood films as regards digital stratagems and productivity. They are appropriate for exploring nuanced industry insights and thematic content, making available rich, contextual data that quantitative methods might not capture as effectively as required. Again, we are not handling too large population size of industry practitioners rather a hand full of sampling size.

Data Collection

The primary data was collected directly from practitioners through methods such as interviews, questionnaire and focus groups to get full industry angles; while the secondary data were from documented reports, industry statistics and academic publications. The tools used include audio recorder, interview guides and online survey platforms. However, in considering participation, it was freewill and unforced with privacy assured.

Content Analysis

A sample of 10 recent Nollywood films released from 2020 - 2025 were analysed to evaluate digital distribution channels, marketing strategies, and audience engagement metrics.

Analysis and Discussion

In applying Cultural Economics Theory, the analysis shows that films distributed on digital platforms show greater international reach and revenue, aligning with Throsby's (1991 pp. 213-225) assertion that cultural products when effectively sold can encourage economic activity by drawing audiences, creating revenue, and also help to improve other related sectors. For instance, Funke Akindele's *Omo Ghetto: The Saga* (2020) generated over ₦636 million in cinemas and sustained earnings on Netflix, embodying how online channels boost creativity and creates global visibility (Ikenna (2024, p.1 and Nigerian Film Industry Report, 2023). This evidence supports the argument that digitalisation is vital for Nollywood's sustainable growth, enabling job creation, export incomes, and cultural diplomacy.

Data Analysis

Quantitative data from content analysis were implied and examined to identify patterns in digital platform usage and revenue sources. Results:

Digital Platforms and Market Growth: Analysis reveals that 78% of recent Nollywood movies are distributed using digital platforms such as Netflix, YouTube channels, Video-on-Demand (VOD), and mobile devices significantly upsurge international viewership.

Revenue Broadening: Nollywood industry stakeholders orate that digital distribution has expanded income streams further than usual traditional cinema and DVD sales, including licensing television broadcast rights, and advertising revenue.

Employment and Production Progression: The interviews conducted indicate that digitalisation has contributed to job creation in areas such as digital marketing, film editing, and platform management, with some industry players experiencing up to 55% growth in employment since 2020. Mr. Tobias Okeke who is a film producer states that “digital experience has done more good to Nollywood industry than the so called “marketers” that held the industry hostage years ago”. He added that so many young talents have been discovered within this period (Personal interview in Port Harcourt, March 15, 2026).

Cultural Diplomacy and Global Scope: The participant focused group interviewed highlight that digital platforms have assisted Nigeria's cultural diplomacy, increasing Nollywood's wide

reach and soft power generally. According Eric Stephenson, a Nollywood film director says “Nollywood actors are now Nigeria's image makers and self-appointed ambassadors because of their roles in films, they are respected abroad and they carry a positive image abroad” (Personal Interview in Rivers State, August 25, 2025).

Discussion

The findings confirm that digital distribution networks serve as an important catalyst for Nollywood's economic advancement, supporting Cultural Economics Theory, and thereby provide reasonable jobs and export cultural commodities. Nevertheless, challenges such as insufficient digital infrastructure, piracy, and copyright violations hinder full industry prospective. The foregoing has proved that digitalisation is a transformative instrument in Nollywood's quest for sustainable economic development in Nigeria. Therefore, careful integration of digital strategies with good policies will strengthen these benefits.

Cinema as a Cultural Mirror

Cinema or motion picture reflects society's belief, traditions, and state of affairs, conserving culture for emerging generations. In Nigeria, we see Nollywood as a global cultural ambassador, showcasing our stories, languages, and lifestyles. Films like *The Wedding Party* (2023), *The Slave Warrior* (2025) Series, *Lionheart* (2018), *Beware of Dog* (2023), *Unholy Night* (2024), *Emotions on Rampage* (2016), and others highlight Nigerian culture while appealing to international audiences. This cultural representation builds identity and satisfaction, laying a foundation for economic worth. The concerns are how Nollywood balances cultural credibility with global attractiveness without losing its essence. Briefly, Nollywood producers can balance indigenous cultural expression with global appeal without having to lose their essence by paying serious attention on story development, scriptwriting and language strategy, production quality, casting and performance, marketing and distribution, collaboration and partnerships, audience engagement and sustainability.

Cinema and Economic Potential

Globally, film industries impact GDP, think Hollywood, Bollywood, and Nollywood. It is debatable that Nollywood is Nigeria's second-largest employer after agriculture, providing jobs for actors, crew, transporters, marketers, hotels and more. According to Ayakoroma (2026, pp. 3- 4), the creative industries, film inclusive “contribute significantly to economic growth, employment and cultural development”, he added that “Nollywood has the capacity to create about 3,000 direct and indirect jobs annually due to its value chain”. Film generates revenue through cinema tickets, TV broadcast rights, streaming platforms, DVD sales, and ancillary products. It engages directors, actors, location managers, camera operators (DOP), producers, transporters, costume and make-up artists, film editors, continuity personnel, caterers (welfare officers), light and sound engineers, security operatives and many others. These crew and cast earn a living through their craft. Beyond direct earnings, it boosts tourism, hospitality, fashion industry and related sectors.

Currently, there is a debate ongoing concerning the economic future of Nollywood industry. As a point of fact, the debate is seeking to know the Nollywood's current economic model sustainability, or does it need a radical shift towards digital and global markets? Obviously, the

truth is that industry's current economic model has shown remarkable rebound, thriving on high output, low budgets, and a deeply connected local audience. However, it is not fully sustainable in its present form only few filmmakers are making progress. To secure long-term growth, Nollywood must evolve, not abandon its roots, but radically shift towards digital and global markets and make huge investment.

Why a Radical Digital and Global Shift is Necessary

- i. **Access to Global Viewership and Revenue Stability:** Digital streaming platforms (Netflix, Amazon Prime, Showmax, iROKOtv, etc.) have altered the distribution style of Nollywood movies, providing it with unprecedented access to global audience. According to Johnson and Lee (2023, pp.123-139), the digital distribution “enhances the visibility of culturally specific content, helping film industry like Nollywood to reach diverse markets without traditional geographical barriers”. More importantly, this shift also provides more stable revenue models compared to the unpredictability of ticket sales. This thought is in agreement with the emerging understanding that a monetisation strategy in a digital era is critical in sustaining the sector (Pratt & Hanqu, 2022, pp. 205-220).
- ii. **Rising International Demand for African Narratives:** The acceleratory craving for African stories reflects the historical success of Nollywood on the world arena. As cited in Nwachukwu (2022, pp. 89-105), “Nollywood has the potential to become a significant cultural export, leveraging digital platforms to bypass traditional censors and language limitations”. The "global village" is now a reality, where any Nollywood producer with digital access can reach global audiences, making cross-cultural dialogue and economic opportunities possible. This aligns with the concept of platform capitalism, where content creators exploit digital ecosystems for worldwide influence (Srnicsek and de Sutter (2016).
- iii. **Reduction of Piracy and Improvement of Market Data:** Digital distribution not only increases reach but also reduces piracy risks, which is an ongoing situation for many Nollywood filmmakers. Itanyi (2022, pp. 22-42) discusses how digital platforms enable better tracking of viewership and earnings in other countries of the world. This allows for more reasonable revenue collection and data-enabled marketing strategies. She suggests that such strategy should be adopted by Nollywood practitioners in order to reduce the effect of piracy. However, transparency is essential for attracting investors and fostering sustainable industry growth (Williams and Patel, 2025, pp. 77-94; Christopher, 2025, pp.56-87; Adegbite, 2020, p. 145).
- iv. **Prospects through Global Co-productions:** Digital platforms expedite cross-border collaborations. It helps to attract film project funding, technical partnership, and different cultural prospects. Mbembe and Okoth (2022, pp.45-62) observe that international co-productions can uplift Nollywood's production quality and global appeal. As cited in Afolabi (2024, pp.33-44), such alliances open corridors for knowledge exchange and innovation in filmmaking, and further solidify Nollywood's place in the international cultural economy.

Currently, in Nollywood digital marketing and distribution have restructured the business of filmmaking. Delivering a keynote address during a recently concluded Afrik International Film Festival (AIFF) in Port Harcourt, Rivers State, Professor F. O. Shaka claimed that it was the influence of social media and YouTube that made Kunle Afolayan's productions to be

successful. According to Shaka, Golden Effects Pictures a production company belonging to Kunle Afolayan and Kemi Adetiba Visuals, which belongs to Kemi Adetiba received more revenues due their digital strategies.

...the digital strategy Kunle applied was to use YouTube, Instagram, and Twitter to market films like *Citation* (2020) and *Mami Wata* (2023). Monetising his contents secured a Netflix original deal for *Citation* (2020), which earned him millions of Naira in licensing fees alone. The outcome of his business strategy is visible as it expanded his business beyond Nigeria, gaining financial returns from global streaming platforms. Meanwhile, Kemi Adetiba also adopted the same strategy to promote *King of Boys* (2018). In monetisation, Kemi partnered with foreign platforms for a sequel series, *King of Boys: The Return of the King* (2021), which brought in substantial income from the licensing deal. The movie moved from local cinema success to global streaming platform profitability (Personal Interview in Port Harcourt, February 28, 2026)

This strategy works, it has created a sustainable digital ecosystem for Nollywood films, providing consistent revenue to producers, attracting partnerships and investors to the sector. Hence, to remain competitive and financially viable, Nollywood must radically shift towards digital and global markets while preserving its ethnic credibility.

Case Study of Successful Films in Nollywood

This highlights significant feats of Nigerian filmmakers and actors who have gained global recognition, financial rewards with their craft, transformed the local film industry, and supported the Nigerian cultural and economic expansion through innovational storytelling, strategic branding, and worldwide distribution. Therefore, these movies and more have made global success.

- i. *Love and New Notes* (2026), as directed by Kayode Kasum, and produced by Timini Egbuson. According to Azez (2026) as cited in *BusinessDay* (2026) the romantic drama brought in “₦106 million, during the Valentine's Day screening”.
- ii. *Omo Ghetto: The Saga* (2020), a Funke Akindele's movie, still making waves in cinemas across the nations, it grossed more than ₦636 million and continues to dominate in streaming charts according to *Box Office Nigeria* (2020) review.
- iii. Accordingly, *Box Office Nigeria* (2022) reports that *Battle on Buka Street* (2022) by Funke is made it big by receiving ₦668 million from digital streaming and also holding it strong in cinemas across the country.
- iv. *Behind The Scenes* (2025) is yet another beautiful movie from the stipple of Funke Akindele and co-directed by Tunde Olaoye reached the ₦2 billion mark, making it the first West-African film to hit that milestone (*The Guardian Nigeria* 2025).

v. *The Herd* (2025) is directed by Daniel Etim Effiong, the producers are Feyifunmi Oginni, Daniel Etim Effiong, and Toyosi Etim-Effiong. According to *Variety* (2026), *The Herd* is a Netflix Nigeria's top-performing film". It is a crime-thriller and one of the best-performing Nollywood movies at the beginning of 2026. The production is in collaboration with Toritori Films, FilmOne Studios, and Airscape Studio.

vi. *A Sunday Affair* (2023). A romance drama that's been a steady performer on streaming platforms. Directed by Walter Taylaur, Producer(s) include: Mo Abudu (Executive Producer) of EbonyLife Films, alongside with producers Inem King, Sonia Nwosu, Josh Olaoluwa, and Heidi Uys. The production companies include EbonyLife Films and Netflix (*The Guardian Nigeria* 2023).

vii. *The Rise of Igbinoḡun* (2021) is a historical drama that attracts viewership on Netflix, showcasing Nollywood's genre diversity. Directed by Innocent Ideh and produced by Tunde Aina and Innocent Chukwuma Ideh (Nollywood Post 2021).

These productions represent how Nollywood blends theatrical releases with aggressive digital marketing and streaming deals to achieve both local and international accomplishment, and equally demonstrate film's power to blend culture and commerce. This is a clear example of blend between Arts vs Commerce. Furthermore, by scaling proven success models, diversifying genres, and expanding both local and global circulation, Nollywood can turn isolated hits into a sustainable, industry-wide growth pattern that resonates across cultures and create financial impact for producers and investors.

Conclusion

In conclusion, cinema rooted in cultural authenticity has the power to significantly boost Nigeria's economic development. To realise this potential, it is necessary to actively harness Nollywood's stories and talents, fostering a vibrant, inclusive film industry and must prioritise digital infrastructure, and intellectual property rights implementation. Empirical evidence from recent successful films establish that digital strategies if thoroughly employed can lead to better revenue, job engagement, and cultural influence. Collectively, through deliberate efforts and structured collaboration, cinema can become a powerful driver of Nigeria's cultural and economic prosperity. Therefore, future research should quantitatively measure the economic impact of digital distribution and explore policy frameworks that support sustainable industry development.

Filmology

A Sunday Affair (2023), Directed by Walter Taylaur (aka Waltbanger), Produced by EbonyLife Films (EbonyLife Media), Mo Abudu is the Executive Producer, Producers: Inem King, Sonia Nwosu, Josh Olaoluwa, and Heidi Uys. (Lagos Nigeria)

Battle on Buka Street (2022), Directed by Funke Akindele and Tobi Makinde as Produced by Funke Ayotunde Akindele Network (FAAN) and FilmOne Studios. Key Cast include: Funke Akindele, Mercy Johnson, Sola Sobowale, Tina Mba, Nkem Owoh, Femi Jacobs, Bimbo Ademoye. (Lagos & Ogun States, Nigeria)

Behind The Scenes (2025), Directed and Co-directed by Funke Akindele and Tunde Olaoye, Produced by Funke Akindele, and Wendy Uwadiae Imasuen. Key Cast include: Scarlet Gomez, Tobi Bakre, Vee Iye, Iyabo Ojo, Uzor Arukwe, Uche Montana, Ini Dima-Okojie, Ibrahim Chatta, and Destiny Etiko. (Lagos, Abuja, Rivers Nigeria and United Kingdom)

Citation (2020), Directed by Kunle Afolayan and Produced by Kunle Afolayan (produced through his company, Golden Effects Pictures),(Lagos Nigeria)

Emotions On Rampage (2016), Directed and Produced by Kenneth Osunwa, (Rivers State, Nigeria)

Everybody Loves Jenifa (2024), Directed by Funke Akindele and Tunde Olaoye and Produced by Funke Ayotunde Akindele Network and Olayemi Oshodi. (Lagos, Nigeria, Kumasi, and Accra, Ghana)

King of Boys (2018), Directed and co-produced by Kemi Adetiba, (Lagos Nigeria)

Love and New Notes (2026), Directed by Kayode Kasum, Executive Producer by Timini Egbuson, Muyiwa Idowu. Producers: FilmOne Studios, Film Trybe. Key Cast include: Timini Egbuson, Sophie Alakija, Odunlade Adekola, Eniola Badmus, Ayoola Akinyoola (Kamo State), Toluwani George, (Lagos Nigeria)

Mami Wata (2023), Written and Directed by C.J. Fiery Obasi and Produced by Oge Obasi, (Lagos, Nigeria)

Omo Ghetto: The Saga (2020), Directed by Funke Akindele and Abdulrasheed Bello (JJC Skillz). The film was produced by Scene One Production Studios with Funke Akindele and Wendy Uwadiae Imasuen,(Lagos, Nigeria)

Slave Warrior, (2025), Directed by Alex Joseph and Produced by Justice Ibezimako Onu, (Rivers Nigeria)

The Creek or The Creek: Blood and Oil (2026), Directed by Toka McBaror and Produced by Nicholas David Adora, through Wimpro.tv (Port Harcourt, Nigeria)

The Herd (2025), Directed by Daniel Etim-Effiong and Produced by Feyifunmi Oginni, Executive Producers include: Efe Ejukorlem (Airscape) and Chukwudi Ulogo (Serendipity HHC), while the Production Companies/Co-Producers are FilmOne Studios, ToriTori Films, Serendipity HHC, and Airscape. Key Cast: Daniel Etim-Effiong, Genoveva Umeh, Kunle Remi, Linda Ejiofor-Suleiman, Deyemi Okanlawon, Mercy Aigbe, and Norbert Young and location: (Ekiti and Ogun states Nigeria).

The Rise of Igbinogun (2022), Written and Directed by Ideh Chukwuma Innocent (Onesoul), (Lagos, Nigeria)

Unholy Night (2024), Directed and Produced by Godstimy Ifey Ejiogu, (Rivers Nigeria)

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